MANILA

A far-eastern business contest
for 3 to 5 players aged 10 and up

It is 1821, and for 250 years the Philippine Islands have been under the thumb of the Spanish crown. In the shadow of the colonial power, self-willed natives have established secret maritime trade with the Asiatic mainland. Using odd-looking punts and fragile bamboo barks, these black market traders cram their boats with nutmeg, silk, jade, and ginseng, and set sail to smuggle them into MANILA. Success in each venture is uncertain, as the seaworthiness of both boats and captains is poor. To add to their woes, pirates lie in wait to plunder boats that cannot escape them.
Given all this, it is not surprising that wares that reach the black markets in MANILA command high prices, making the venture worth the risk for those who succeed. The black market dealers use accomplices to ensure they get the wares, bribe pilots to aid their cargoes and hinder others, and insure their cargoes against failure. And a few wealthy merchants hire pirates to attack the black market boats and secretly pocket the profits from these raids.

fig. 1: showing the contents, game board descriptions

Contents:


4 ware loads
for the 4 wares


4 dice (in the colors
of the 4 wares)


4 value indicators (in the
colors of the 4 wares)



20 shares:
5 each of
4 wares

79 coins of the Philippine
currency, "PESO"

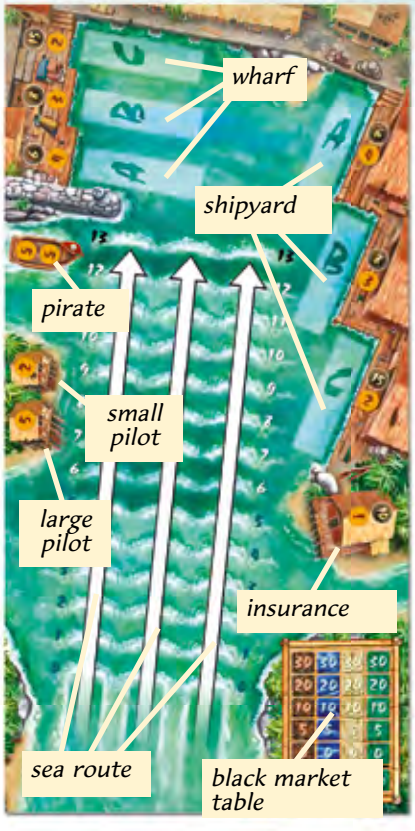


20 accomplices
in five colors

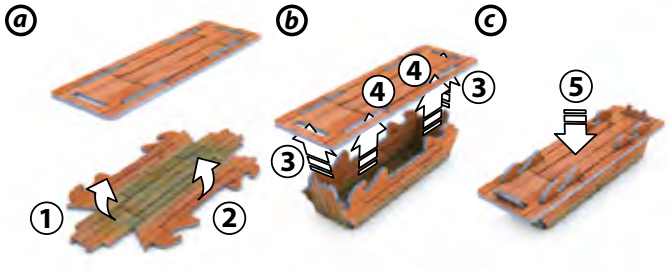



3 punts

1 game board



Before the first game, assemble
the three punts like this:



Game overview

The game is played over several rounds (called voyages). In each voyage, 3 punts are loaded with wares and set sail for MANILA. At the beginning of each voyage, the office of the harbor master is auctioned. The office is important, as only the harbor master can decide which wares will be loaded and where the punts will sail from, giving some advantages over others. The harbor master is also the only one able to buy a new share as an investment in the future.
Once the harbor master has executed the duties of his office, all players hire accomplices to help them earn money on the voyage.
At the end of each voyage, players receive profits for successful accomplices. Wares, which reach MANILA, rise in value on the black market. The game ends as soon as one ware value reaches 30. The player who has accumulated the largest fortune is the winner.

Preparation:

Each player takes
- **30 PESOS**
- **2 shares**
- **3 accomplices**

(game for 3: 4 accomplices)



- Each player takes 30 PESOS. Place the remaining coins as a harbor cash box next to the game board.
- Each player takes three accomplices in his color. Place unused figures back in the box

When playing with just three, each player takes four accomplices.
Find other rule changes for playing with three in red on page 3.

Each player gets 2 of the well shuffled shares and looks at them without showing them to the other players. Now sort all remaining shares by ware and place them next to the game board (see fig. 2a).
- Place the four value indicators on space "0" of the black market table, matching their colors to those on the table (see fig. 2b).
- Place the punts, ware loads, and dice next to the game board.



fig. 2a: sort the remaining shares by ware and place them next the board as shown.



fig. 2b: the black market table at the beginning of the game.

Playing the game:

The game is played in several consecutive voyages.

Each voyage is played in the following order:
1. The office of harbor master is auctioned
2. The office of harbor master is performed.
3. Place accomplices and move punts by rolling dice (= “place and roll dice”)
4. Profit distribution
5. Ware values rise

1. The office of harbor master is auctioned

For the first voyage, the oldest player starts the auction with a bid of at least 1 PESO (or passes). For subsequent voyages, the player who was harbor master for the previous voyage, starts the bidding. If the starting player passes, his left neighbor begins, and so forth around the table, in clockwise order.
The auction continues in clockwise order, with each player, on his turn, passing or offering a higher bid. Once a player has passed in the auction for a voyage, he cannot re-enter the bidding at a later point. The auction continues until all have passed, but one. This player has won the auction. He pays his last bid amount to the harbor cash box and is now the new harbor master. If no player bids in the auction, the previous harbor master retains the office for this voyage.

The player who bids highest, becomes the harbor master.

No player may bid more than he is able to pay. A player may take a loan by encumbering any of his shares, to get the money he needs to pay his bid (see “Take out a loan”).

2. The harbor master performs the duties of his office:

The harbor master…
a)… may buy a share
b)… has to decide which loads will be transported
c)… has to place the punts in the water.



a) Buy a share

The harbor master may take a desired share from the game board. He pays the cost to the harbor cash box and places the share face-down with his unencumbered shares.
The cost of a share is determined by the current value of the ware on the black market. It is at least 5 PESOS.



fig. 3: a nutmeg share currently costs 10 PESOS and a silk share costs 20 PESOS. Ginseng currently has no value on the black market, but the harbor master would pay 5 PESOS for a share, as he would for a jade share, which is currently valued at 5 PESOS on the black market.

Harbor master may buy 1 share Price = value of that ware on black market table, but, at least, 5 PESOS.



b) Load goods

Now the harbor master loads one ware on each of the three punts. It is his decision alone, which ware he does not load (see fig. 4).



fig. 4: the harbor master decided not to load silk.

Harbor master loads 3 wares and leaves one ashore.

c) Place punts in water

Now the harbor master is to place the three punts in the water, thus determining their starting positions. For each punt there is a sea route on the board with spaces numbered from 0 to 13, ending at the destination port.

- The harbor master places each punt on one of the sea routes, but never two punts on the same sea route.
- When he places a punt, he places it on one of the start positions on the sea route selected, numbered 0 to 5. He must not place any punt in a position higher than space 5 (spaces 0 to 5 are marked to reinforce this rule).
- Note, however, that **the sum of the numbers of the 3 start position MUST always add to exactly 9** (see fig. 5a and 5b).

Harbor master determines the start spaces for the 3 punts. The sum of the start spaces = 9. No punt may start past space 5.



fig. 5a: when one sums the 3 start positions, they must always equal 9. For example, one punt can begin in space 4, another in space 3, so the last would have to be in space 2.



fig. 5b: the harbor master may place a punt on space 0, if the sum of the other two positions (e.g. 4+5) is equal to 9.

the three sea routes



Alternate accomplice placing and punt moving (total of 3 each).

Game for 3: before the first punt moving, play 2 accomplice placing rounds (=4 placing rounds +3 moving rounds).

3. Place accomplices and move punts

This phase has three accomplice placing rounds, each followed by a punt movement round. After the first accomplice placing round comes the first punt movement round, and so forth.

In a game with three players there are 4 accomplice placing rounds and 3 punt movement rounds: after the first accomplice placing round, there is a second accomplice placing round. Then comes the first punt movement round. After that, the rounds alternate as in the four-player game.

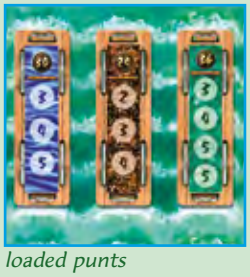
Place accomplices:

Beginning with the harbor master, and continuing in clockwise order, each player takes turns placing one of his accomplices on any vacant accomplice space and pays the amount shown on that space to the harbor cash box (exception: insurance, see below).
At any time, a player may choose to refrain from placing an accomplice on his turn. However, once a player has done so, he may place no further accomplices for this voyage.
If a player has no money and is also not able to take out a loan he may place accomplices as "blind passengers" for free (see "take out a loan" and "blind passenger").

Accomplice placing round: each player places 1 accomplice. Harbor master starts.

WHERE TO PLACE ACCOMPLICES?

Players can deploy their accomplices on the following places:


loaded punts

Wares (on board the punts):

For ginseng, silk, and nutmeg, there are three accomplice spaces, and for jade there are four accomplice spaces.
When a player wants to place an accomplice on one of the 3 loaded wares, he should choose the lowest-priced empty space of the desired ware. Each player may place several accomplices on the same ware punt, if the space is available on his turns. Punts already docking at the port cannot take any new accomplices.

- → The goal of this action: to have accomplices on a punt that reaches the port destination on this voyage, so the player can share in the profits (see: phase III: "profit distribution").
- → The risk of this action: if the chosen punt does not reach the destination port, there is no profit to share, and the player gets no return on his accomplice investment.


port

Port and shipyard spaces:

At each port and shipyard space, there is an accomplice place. In addition to the punt placements, players may deploy their accomplices on any vacant port or shipyard space. As with the ware spaces on the punts, a player can deploy several accomplices on port and shipyard spaces, when they are vacant on his turns.

- → The goal of this action: to have accomplices on spaces where punts arrive at the end of the voyage, so the player can earn the payment shown above the deployment space (see phase III: "profit distribution").
- → The risk of this action: if no punt reaches the chosen port, the player gets no return on his accomplice investment.


shipyard


pirate boat

Pirate spaces:

In the pirate boat are two accomplice spaces. The first to use the pirate boat will take the front space and become the captain. If the captain space is occupied, the player places his accomplice in the second space. One player can have accomplices in both spaces.

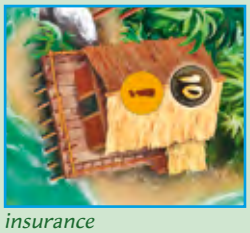
- → The goal of this action: the pirates may board a punt that ends the second movement round on space 13 and may plunder any punt that ends its movement on the third round on space 13 (see "here come the pirates").
- → The risk of this action: if no punt reaches space 13, the player gets no return on his accomplice investment.


pilot island

Pilot spaces:

The pilot island offers two accomplice spaces. When a player places an accomplice on one of these (vacant) spaces, he chooses between the "large" one, which is more expensive, but offers a better return or the "small" one.

- → The goal of this action: before the third round of punt movement, the pilots have an opportunity to aid or hinder punts that have not yet reached their ports. Punts that reached their ports before round three cannot be affected by the pilots (see "the pilots do their thing").
- → The risk of this action: the exercised influence does not achieve the desired goal.


insurance

Insurance:

The insurance office has an accomplice space. The player who places an accomplice here, pays nothing, but immediately receives an "insurance" payment of 10 PESOS from the harbor cash box.

- → The goal of this action: if, after three movment rounds, no punt lands at the shipyard, the player keeps the 10 PESOS insurance payment.
- → The risk of this action: for each punt that lands at the shipyard, the insurance agent must pay the repair cost. In addition, the insurance agent takes over the profit disbursement to accomplices on those spaces (see: "the insurance pays")

Movement rounds:

The harbor master rolls the three dice, whose **colors** correspond to the **loaded wares.** Then he moves each of the three punts - in any order - along its sea route the number of spaces shown on its die (see fig. 6).

- When a punt reaches its destination port with movement points remaining, these are "discarded". In no other case, may the harbor master choose to "discard" a punt's movement points.
- Each punt must move only on its sea route. Sea route changes are not allowed.
- Punts may not lose or exchange wares along the way.



fig. 6: The brown "nutmeg die" shows a 4. Therefore, the harbor master moves the punt loaded with nutmeg 4 spaces in the direction of its port destination. He moves the silk punt 2 spaces forward. The jade junk reaches its port destination with 2 movement points remaining. These are discarded.



Punt moving round: Harbor master rolls the 3 dice that match the wares loaded on the 3 punts and moves the punts forward based on the die rolls.



Successful voyage

Each punt which travels past space 13, reaches its destination port of MANILA. The first punt to reach MANILA is placed in port **space A,** the **second** is placed in port **space B,** and the **third** is placed in port **space C** (see fig. 7). No port space can get 2 punts.



fig. 7: The jade punt reached MANILA in the second round and now occupies port space A. In the third round, the other two punts reach MANILA. They are placed on port spaces B and C, without regard to which is placed where. If one of these two had not reached MANILA, port space C would remain vacant, and this punt would be placed on shipyard space Shipwrecks A.

Punts which move past space 13 arrive at the destination port.

Shipwrecks

Punts, which fail to reach MANILA after **three movement rounds**, are damaged and must be placed in the **shipyard** (**exception:** punts which end movement in rounds 2 or 3 on space 13 are affected by the pirates; see "here come the pirates") and may or may not be placed in the shipyard. When only one punt fails to reach MANILA, it is placed on shipyard **space A**.
A **second punt** failing to reach MANILA is placed on shipyard **space B**. If **all three punts fail** to reach MANILA, the last is placed on shipyard **space C** (see fig. 8). No shipyard space can get 2 punts.



fig. 8: Only the silk punt arrived in MANILA. The other two punts failed to reach MANILA, or even space 13. They are both placed in the shipyard, in spaces A and B.

Punts that do not reach space 13 after 3 moving rounds are placed in the shipyard. There are 3 spaces each (A, B, and C) in the port and shipyard for punts that land there.

NOTE: immediately before the third movement round, the pilots have the opportunity to influence movement of the punts (see "the pilots do their thing")!

Here come the pirates

When a punt stops on space 13 at **the end of a movement round**, the pirates attack the punt.

a) Punts standing **after the second movement round** on space 13, are **boarded** by the pirates.
b) Punts standing **after the third movement round** on space 13, are **plundered** by the pirates.

A punt which arrives on space 13 other than at the end of a movement round, but by pilot influence, is not affected by the pirates (see "the pilots do their thing"). **If there are no pirates on the pirate boat at the time of the punt's arrival on space 13**, the punt is not attacked.

Punts stopping on space 13 are boarded or plundered by the pirates.



Board: Only after the second movement round! Pirates may be placed on a vacant space of the punts.

a) boarded by pirates (see fig. 9)

To board the punt, the player moves his pirate to a vacant space on the punt. If there is no vacant space in the punt, it **cannot be boarded** (see fig. 9).
The pirate captain (forward space in the pirate boat) may board first. After he boards (or refrains from boarding), the second pirate may board. The choice to board or not is solely the choice of each pirate in order. Each may choose to remain on the pirate boat in the hopes of later plunder (see "plunder").

If the second pirate remains alone in the pirate boat, he becomes the new pirate captain.

When the pirate captain boards a punt, the second pirate immediately becomes the pirate captain, moving to the forward position in the pirate boat. If there are several punts standing on space 13 after the second movement round, the pirates are free to choose which, if any punts to board, but must board vacant spaces only.



fig. 9: After the second movement round, the jade and ginseng punts are both on space 13. The pirate captain decides to board. As there is only vacant space on the ginseng punt, he boards here. There is no further vacant space on either punt, so the second pirate moves forward to become the pirate captain.

Note: players can increase the power of pirates somewhat by using the rule variant described at the end of these rules.

Plunder: Only after the third movement round! The pirates share the profits of the wares plundered.

The pirate captain decides to send the plundered punts to the harbor or to the shipyard.

b) Plunder (see fig. 10)

Each punt, which stands on space 13 after the third movement round, falls completely into the hands of the pirates:

- All accomplices on the punt are removed and returned to their players.
- The pirates receive the income for each plundered punt from the harbor cash box (see chapter 3: "profit distribution").
- Now, the pirate captain decides for each plundered punt separately whether it lands at the port or the shipyard. If he chooses the port for a punt, the value of the plundered ware rises in value (see "ware value rising").

When a punt stands on space 13 after the third movement round and there are no pirates on the pirate boat, it is placed on the next vacant port space. and is treated as if it arrived at the destination port.



fig. 10: The nutmeg punt stands on space 13 after the third movement round. All accomplices on the punt are returned to their players with no profit. The pirates share the profit from the nutmeg punt of 24 PESOS (12 PESOS each) from the harbor cash box.

Before the 3rd movement round:
• the "small pilot" moves 1 punt by one space
• the "big pilot" moves 1 punt (2 spaces) or 2 punts (each by one space)

The pilots do their thing

At the end of the last accomplice placing round (just before the last punt movement round) the pilots may use their influence on the movement of the punts. Pilots may not influence punts which have already reached MANILA.

- The "small pilot" (on the space costing 2 PESOS) goes first. He may move one punt either forward or backward by one space.
- Next, the "large pilot" takes his turn. He may move one punt up to two spaces or two punts each by one space. He decides for each separately whether to move it forward or backward. Also, he may move the punt the small pilot moved or not, as he chooses (see fig. 11)

When a pilot moves a punt past space 13, it has arrived at its port destination and he places it on the next vacant port space.
When a pilot moves a punt to space 13, nothing happens (the pirates only attack immediately after the movement round).

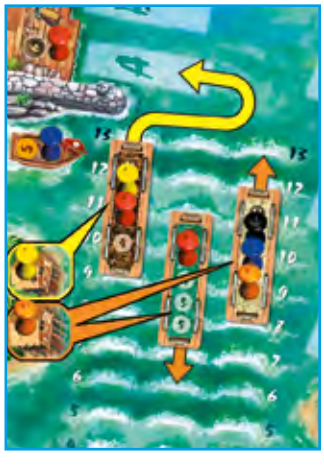


fig 11: The last accomplice placing round has ended. Before the last punt movement round, the harbor master pauses to give the pilots the opportunity to use their influence. The "small pilot" chooses to move the nutmeg punt forward by one space. Because the nutmeg punt has now arrived in MANILA, the small pilot places it on the next vacant port space and the "large pilot" will not be able to move it. The "large pilot" decides to move the jade punt backwards one space and the ginseng punt one space forward to space 13. As the pirates are not now active, they cannot attack the ginseng punt.

- **The harbor master may only roll the dice to move the punts in the third movement round after he has given the pilots the opportunity to execise their actions.**
- **Each pilot decides independently whether to use his influence or not. Thus, for example, the small pilot can choose to refrain, while the large pilot use his influence.**

As soon as all punts have been moved in the third punt movement round and all punts have been placed on port or shipyard spaces, the profits are now paid.

4. Profit distribution

Now the players who placed their accomplices successfully will receive the profits from their successes:

- PIRATE ACCOMPLICES earn a profit only if a punt ended movement in space 13 at the end of punt movement round 3. The pirates plunder these punts, dividing the profits (value printed on ware load) equally between them. If only one pirate is on the pirate boat, he receives the entire profits from the plundered punts. All accomplices on the plundered punts are returned empty-handed to their players (see fig. 10).
- LOADED WARE ACCOMPLICES earn profits only if their punt arrived in the destination port of MANILA. On each ware load is the amount of profit to be earned, which the accomplices share equally among themselves (see fig. 12). All accomplices on a punt that was damaged and sent to the shipyard, go home empty-handed.
- PORT/SHIPYARD ACCOMPLICES earn a profit only if a punt landed at the port or shipyard space where they were deployed (see fig. 13a, 13b). Above the deployment spaces are printed the amounts of profit. The profit for port spaces is paid, in each case, from the harbor cash box. The profit for the shipyard spaces is paid by the insurance agent (if there is no insurance agent, it is paid by the harbor cash box). All accomplices deployed to a vacant port or shipyard space go home empty-handed.



fig. 12: The jade punt arrived in MANILA with 3 accomplices on board. Therefore, each accomplice receives a third of the 36 PESO profit. The red player gets 24 PESOS, as he has 2 accomplices on the jade punt; the yellow player gets 12 PESOS for his accomplice on the jade punt.

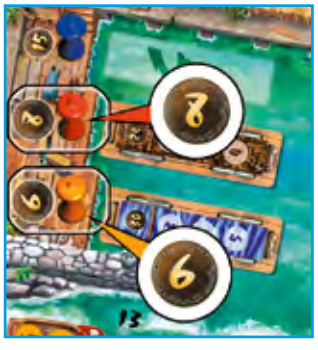


fig. 13a: Because 2 punts reached the destination port, the ORANGE player earns 6 PESOS and the RED player earns 8 PESOS. The BLUE player bet on all 3 punts reaching MANILA, but lost, so he earns nothing for this accomplice.



fig. 13b: Only the ginseng punt landed at the shipyard, earning the BLUE player 6 PESOS. The BLACK player has an accomplice there, but he placed him on the space for two punts landing (shipyard space B) in the shipyard, so he gets nothing.

The insurance pays

Each punt, which lands in the shipyard, is damaged. To repair the damage, the insurance agent must pay (see fig. 14). He pays the insurance

- to the player who deployed an ACCOMPLICE to the shipyard space where the damaged punt landed.
- to the harbor cash box, if no ACCOMPLICE was placed on the shipyard space where the punt landed.

The insurance payment is like a profit, which is paid according to the number printed above the shipyard space where the punt landed (see fig. 14).

The insurance agent player may first take his profits for the voyage before paying for the punt repairs. If he does not have enough cash to make the payments, he must take out loans to cover the missing amounts (see "take out a loan").
If he cannot raise enough cash, even with loans, to pay the entire amount, he pays all that he can and the rest comes from the harbor cash box. The player does not have to repay the amount paid by the harbor cash box in this case.



fig. 14: For both punts that landed in the shipyard, the insurance agent must pay for repairs. He pays 6 PESOS to the BLUE player and 8 PESOS to the ORANGE player. However, as the BLUE player is the insurance agent, he pays only the 8 PESOS to the ORANGE player.

Profits:



A. Pirates receive the profits of plundered punts and share them equally (the harbor cash box pays).

B. Loaded ware accomplices earn profits of the ware arriving in the destination port (the harbor cash box pays).

C. Port accomplices earn a profit if a punt landed at the port space where they were deployed (the harbor cash box pays).

D. Shipyard accomplices earn a profit if a punt landed at the shipyard space where they were deployed. The insurance agent pays. If there is no insurance agent, the harbor cash box pays.

The insurance agent also pays for the repair of punts on shipyard spaces where no accomplice has been placed. This amount he pays to the harbor cash box.

Take out a loan

To encumber one share = 12 Pesos from the harbor cash box. Pay back = 15 Pesos

Each player who has unencumbered shares, can, at any time, take out a loan from the harbor cash box, by encumbering one or more of his unencumbered shares. To indicate the share is encumbered, the player places it apart from his unencumbered shares face-down in his play area. For each share, the harbor cash box will loan 12 PESOS. When a player must make a payment and does not have enough cash, he MUST take out a loan, so that he may settle his commitments. When a player does not have enough cash and potential money from unencumbered shares,

- he may not bid for the office of harbor master with an amount higher than he could raise with his current cash and available loans.
- he must take all the loans he can and pay for the repairs as insurance agent until he has no more unencumbered shares-the remaining amounts will be paid by the harbor cash box (see "the insurance pays").



Encumbered share = minus 15 Pesos at game end.

Each encumbered share may be made unencumbered by repaying the loan, plus interest, for a total of 15 PESOS to the harbor cash box. The player places the now unencumbered share face up back with the other unencumbered shares in his play area. He can, of course, use the share again to take out a loan, if necessary.

At game end, the players must pay back 15 PESOS for each still encumbered share in their play areas (see "game end and the winner").

Blind Passenger

A player who has no cash can place an accomplice for no cost ("blind passenger").

When a player has no cash (and has no unencumbered shares with which to take out loans), he becomes a "Blind Passenger", he may place an accomplice as a blind passenger on any vacant place of any punt for no cost. All other spaces are not available to him until he has cash once more. If after adding all cash and loans, the player still comes short of paying for the least expensive space, he can still place his accomplice on this space but must pay all his remaining cash to the harbor cash box.

5. Ware values rise

Wares, which reach the port, rise in value up by one space on the black market table.

All wares, which were delivered on this voyage to the destination port of MANILA, rise in value. To do this, move the value markers for these wares on the black market table up by one space (e.g. from 0 to 5). Wares that did not reach the harbor remain the same in value.
Next, to prepare for the next voyage, all punts and ware loads are placed at the edge of the game board. The players take all their accomplices back. The next voyage begins with the auction of the office of the harbor master.

Game end & the winner:

Game end: One ware reaches the value of 30.

Winner: The player with the highest fortune (pesos plus unencumbered shares minus encumbered shares).

As soon as the value marker for at least one ware reaches 30 on the black market table, the game ends. Each player counts his cash (PESOS) and adds to this the value of his shares (the value of the ware as shown on the black market table). From this sum, he subtracts 15 PESOS for each encumbered share (loan not yet repaid). This final total is the players FORTUNE.
The player with the highest fortune is the most successful merchant in MANILA, and the winner of the game!

Variant: the pirates are allowed to board a punt even if there are no vacant spaces on them. The boarding player removes one of the accomplices on the punt, returning him to his player, and puting his pirate in his place. If, however, there are vacant spaces on any punt on space 13, these must be filled first by the pirates. Only when there are no vacant spaces can a pirate displace an accomplice on a punt. If both pirates board the same punt, the second pirate may not displace the pirate captain who just boarded the punt.



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Georg Reulein GmbH & Co. KG
Zoch Verlag
Brienner Straße 54a
80333 München
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